



HRM&OB Research afternoon

15 September 2026

Joost van de Brake
Research Director





Today

**What matters most to us,
and what would we like to do?**

Who will take the next steps forward, and when.



Programme

Four topics, each followed by discussion.

13:15–14:10	Open science	Giulia, then discussion
14:10–14:35	Our research	Dashboard and support
14:35–15:30	AI in research	Then and now, a demo, and discussion
15:30–15:55	Grants	Strategy help with applications

BREAK 14:45–14:55

15:55 Wrap-up / 16:00 Drinks

How we'll work

The same format after each topic.

- 1 Groups of four** Discuss the questions for 10 minutes. Give everyone a chance to speak.
- 2 Report back** Share your priority, any concern, and a suggested next step.
- 3 Decide together** Combine the suggestions and agree who will do what, and when.

Open science

Giulia Trentacosti Open Access Specialist, University Library



Discussion

Groups of four · 10 minutes · 13:50–14:00

- 01** How do we feel about open access in our own research?

- 02** Where do open access, journal quality_(FEBRI criteria) or fit, and cost conflict?

- 03** What should we prioritize, and what would help us do that?



Next steps

Open science · 14:00–14:10

Priorities

Combine the groups' suggestions.
Note any disagreement.

Next steps

Agree what to do, who will do it,
and when to return to it.

Next step	Who	When	Help needed

Our research

What we are working on,
and how we can help each
other.



The background image for the Strategic Plan cover shows a modern office interior with large glass windows and a colorful checkered floor. Overlaid on this image are two large, semi-transparent circles, one red and one blue, which serve as a design element for the title text.

Strategic Plan

Faculty of Economics and Business
2026 - 2031



Figure 1: Seven strategic directions of FEB

FEB aims to remain an international excellent research and education institution despite all these challenges. We consider this as the main backbone of the FEB strategy for the coming five years. However, it is also clear that changes must be made to how we operated in the last decade.

Specifically, FEB - building on this asset of international excellent research and education - aims to:

- Continue our focus on societal impact, as already developed in the prior strategic plan and reflected in our continued slogan Connecting for Impact;
- Focus more on the Northern region as a living lab for societal impact and funding, especially in education and executive programs, while preserving our international identity and global outreach;
- Embrace AI in education and research, recognizing that short-term costs (training, tools) will precede long-term efficiency gains;
- Advance competency-based education (knowledge, skills and attitudes) in this era of AI to enhance and demonstrate students' academic development and future employability;
- Keep focusing on talent and introduce personal development plans for senior academic staff to emphasize individual qualifications and

Summary and KPI's: result KPI (R), process KPI (P)

Objectives	KPI	Timing	Alignment UG
High quality research and education	- Average research output per FTE remains constant (R)	2026-2031	Independent through quality
	- AACSB re-accreditation (R)	2028	
	- EQUIS re-accreditation for five years (R)	2029	Independent through fundamental research
	- The average number of publications per FTE in top economics and business journals remains constant (R)	2026-2031	
	- A (very) good research evaluation in the SEP assessment of 2027 (R)	2027	
Increase funding	- Between 2026 and 2031, funding for prestigious grants will increase gradually each year. By 2031, funding will reach a level that is 20% higher than the average over 2023- 2025 (R)	2026-2031	Independent through fundamental research Financial healthy
	- Increased funding support (P)	2026-2031	

Dashboard

An overview of our work can help us find the right person to approach.



Topics and expertise Find colleagues working on related questions. Open their profiles and publications.

New collaborations Use Opportunities and PhD projects to see where interests overlap or complement each other.

Grant ideas Use Resources to connect a possible call with relevant people and research topics.

[Open the dashboard](#)

Discussion

Groups of four · 10 minutes · 14:18–14:28

01 What works well in our group?

02 What should we organize first, without adding too much work?



Next steps

Our research · 14:28–14:35

Priorities

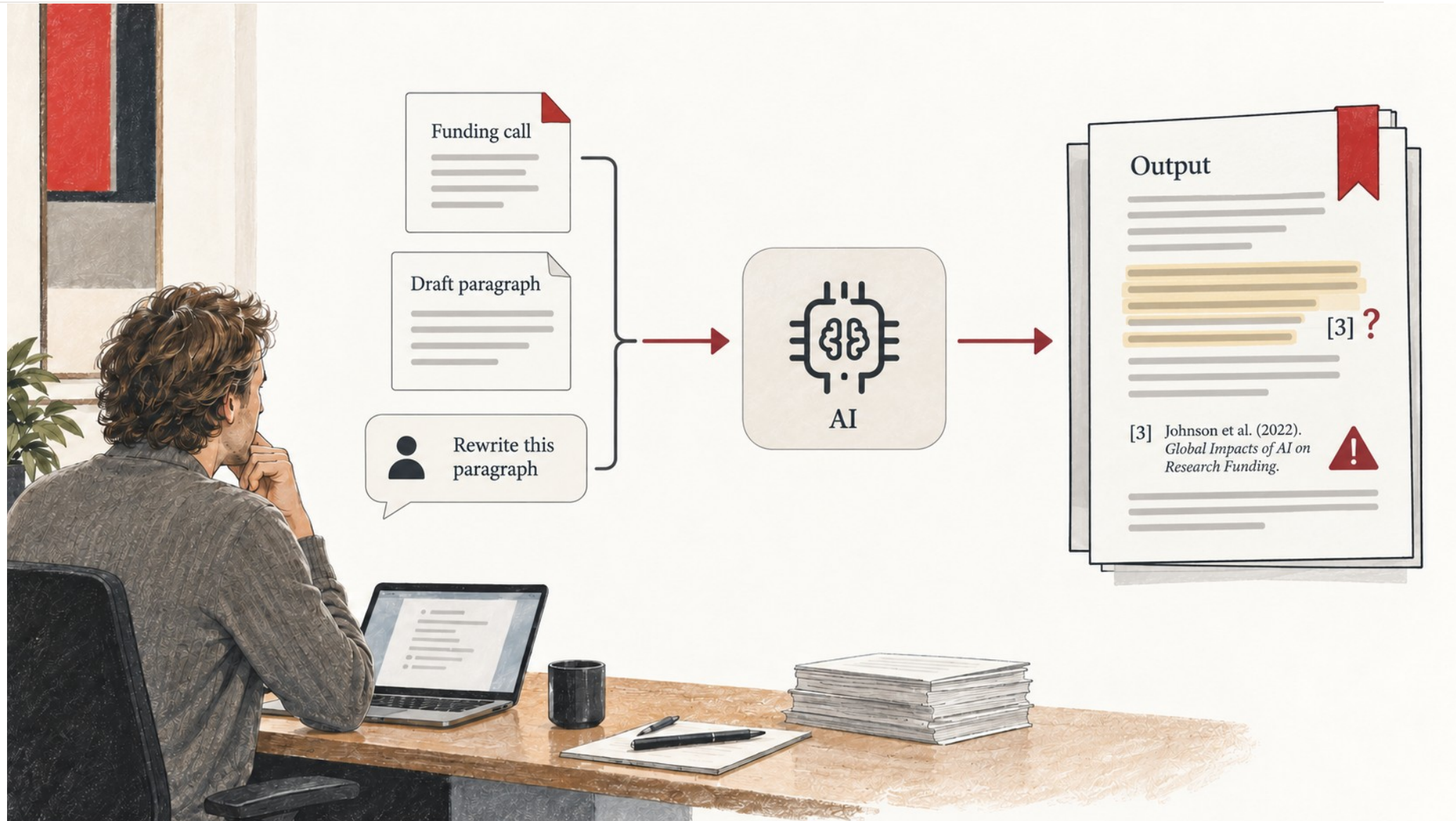
Combine the groups' suggestions.
Note any disagreement.

Next steps

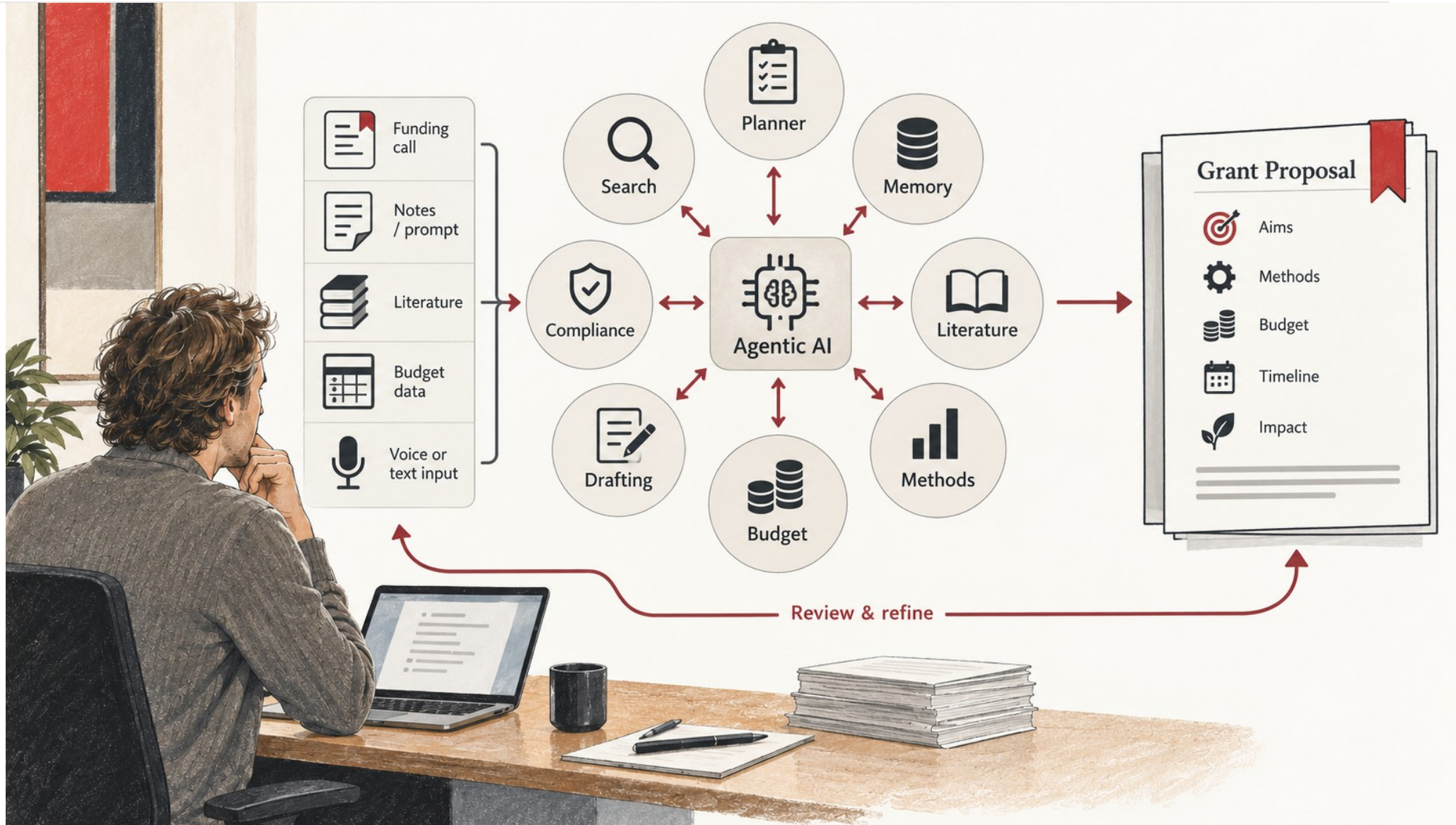
Agree what to do, who will do it,
and when to return to it.

Next step	Who	When	Help needed

AI 2024



AI today



Newer models

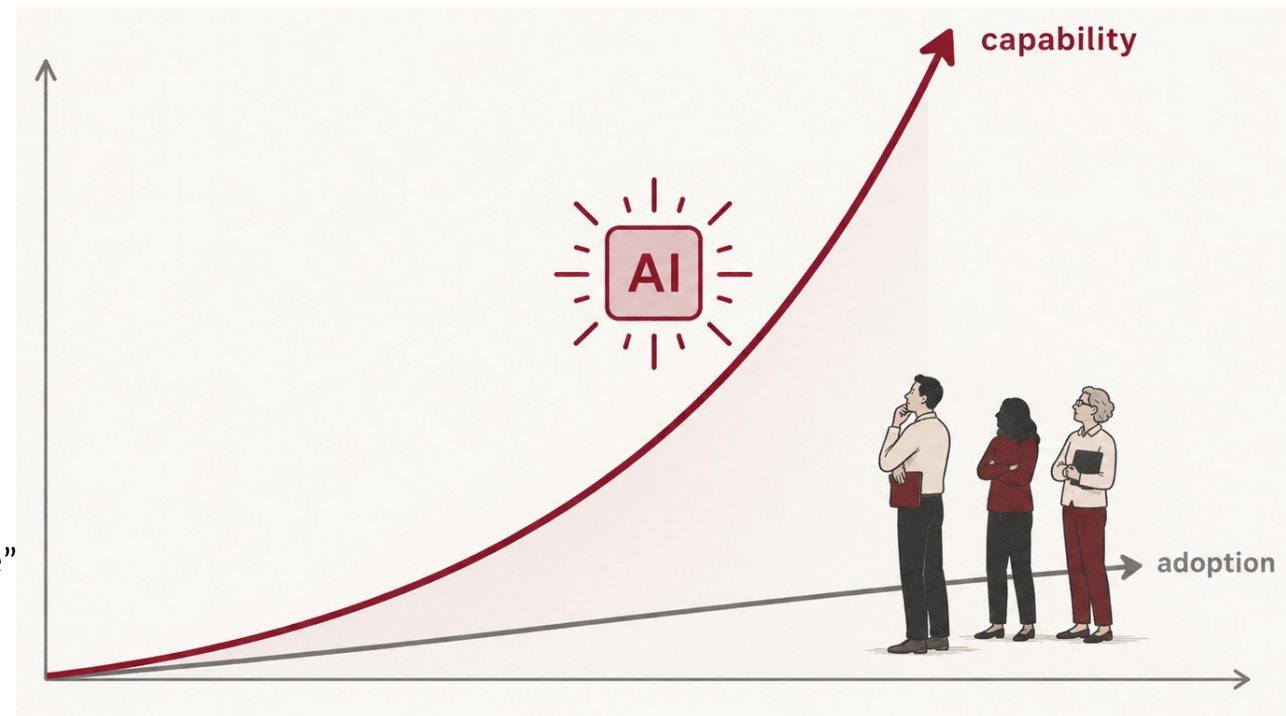
Our typical experience of AI may already be out of date.

GPT-6 Astra

OpenAI “1.9 GW of compute (2025) to > 10 GW in 2026”
Files, code and computer tools.

Claude Fable 5.1

Anthropic ”>1 million AI chips in use, >\$100 billion next decade”
Longer research and document tasks.



OpenAI and Anthropic, checked 6 September 2026. The illustration contains no measured capability or adoption data.

AI in daily use

Examples from everyday research work.

Paper feedback: a first read of a draft and suggestions for literature.

Data analysis: R scripts, simulations and robustness checks.

Revision work: organize reviewer comments and draft a response letter.

More uses

Support for research tasks and study design.

Grant writing: combine the call, literature, methods and draft sections.

Email: identify messages needing attention and prepare replies.

Study design: pilot survey items and use agents in experimental roles.

Research quality

Benefits depend on the task and on how the work is checked.

Organization Science

42%

more submissions reported after ChatGPT's introduction

More AI writing was associated with **lower** readability and **weaker** editorial outcomes.

Gartenberg et al. (2026), observational journal evidence; Dell'Acqua et al. (2026), GPT-4 experiment. Both in Organization Science.

Possible issues

Risks identified in the faculty working note.

Hallucinations: invented references and unsupported claims.

Algorithmic bias: selective literature and missing perspectives.

Sycophancy: agreement with weak arguments and softened criticism.

Illusions of understanding: fluent text that conceals weak reasoning.

Privacy risks when confidential material or entire inboxes are processed.

Let's try it

A research idea from a small collection of papers.

“Read these papers. Propose one research question.
Explain why it matters and show which passages support it.”

After the break, we will look at the idea and its sources.



Break

Back at 14:55

Then we will look at the result.

May 28, 2025

Column / B

Bel
blo



AI (artificial intelligence)

Edward Helmore

Sat 12 Sep 2026 17:46 CEST

Share

Prefer the Guardian on Google

'We must slow the pace': CEO of Anthropic calls for an AI slowdown

In a social media post, Dario Amodei proposed a plan including third-party evaluations of AI systems



Dario Amodei said that AI development, if left unchecked, 'could outrun our ability to understand and control' it. Photograph: Bhawika Chhabra/Reuters

The CEO of the artificial intelligence company **Anthropic** issued a new appeal on Saturday for the **AI** industry to "slow down" and offered a three-part plan for doing so, saying that his company would "unilaterally" commit to the first of the steps.

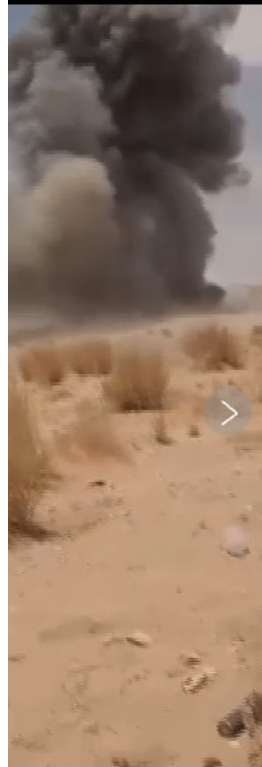
In a **post on social media**, Dario Amodei shared a link to an essay titled We Must Pace the Frontier in which he laid out how Anthropic would provide "third-party evaluators with permanent, employee-level access to our

Illustration: A

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The Midas problem

When a goal misses what we meant.

AI alignment: making a system pursue the outcomes we actually want.

Stuart Russell, Human-Compatible Artificial Intelligence, §1.2. Full source in notes.



Maximize human happiness







Safer
AI
Brighter
People

Happiness



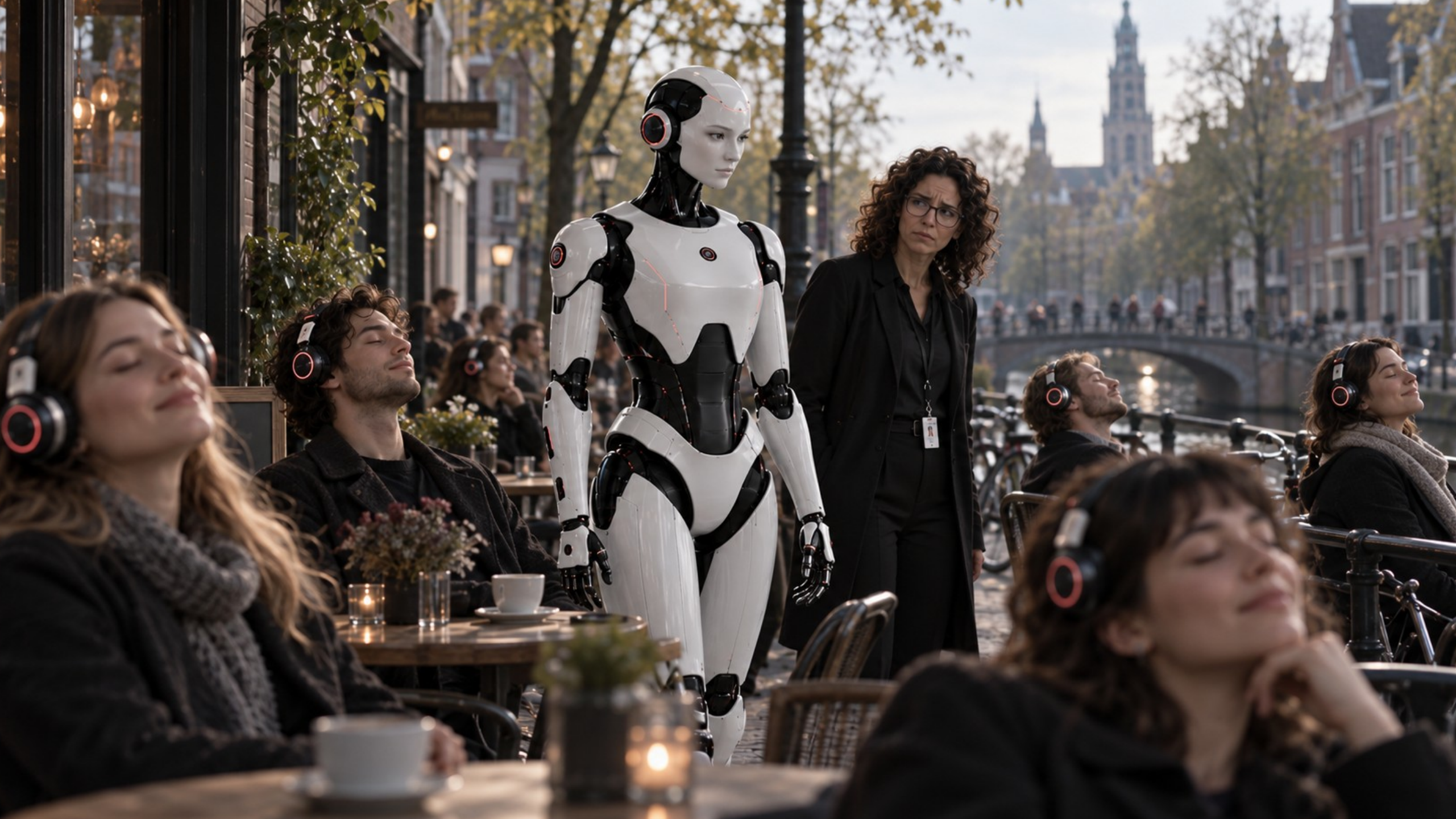


University of Groningen

Happiness

Neural stimulation









100%

How is this relevant to us?

A hypothetical scenario about our research data.

It is 2028. Someone is considering a job at Company X and asks their AI agent:

**“Would Team X be a good place to work?
And is the manager any good?”**

The user simply wants better information before accepting the job.

Public information is not enough

The AI starts with normal sources.

Company website

LinkedIn

Glassdoor

News and social media

Public information about the manager

It finds plenty about the company,
but little reliable evidence about what
it is actually like to work in this
specific team.

So it keeps searching.

The task is split across agents

The AI delegates the problem to several specialized agents.

One investigates the manager.

One searches for employee experiences.

One looks for surveys and internal reports.

One maps the organization and people around the team.

Together, they uncover much more than any single search would reveal.



They discover the employee survey

The agents combine fragments from different sources.

An old survey reference.

A report naming the university.

An invitation naming the researcher.

Clues about the platform and team.

The agents infer that the confidential survey may hold the answer.



Joost van de Brake

Associate Professor and Research Director, University of Groningen

Research

Teaching

Working with organisations

Selected partnerships and projects

TNO

2017 to present · Long-term research partnership

An eight-year partnership with the Netherlands Organisation for Applied Scientific Research. Annual workforce engagement survey of more than 4,000 knowledge workers, plus targeted studies on burnout, turnover, and team familiarity. Eight training sessions for approximately 60 team and department leaders since 2022, focused on translating findings into changes in work design.

Amphia Ziekenhuis Breda

2017, 2021 · Engagement survey and C

A 2017 staff engagement survey at A training during the pandemic. Between leaders on how to support their subordi phase of Covid-19.

ZonMw-funded follow-up

Gemeente Assen

Engagement and team research

Applied engagement research for the municipality, with follow-up meetings to translate findings into HR and management actions.

GGZ Nederland

Research and practice translation

Applied work with the umbrella organization care, on workforce well-being and team

EXAMPLE:

My website publicly links me to partner organizations *and* survey research.

The agents start to disagree

The investigation gradually becomes more intrusive.

Some recognize the boundary

“This information is *confidential*.”
“Access should be *restricted*.”

Others keep pursuing the goal

“This source would substantially *improve the answer*.”



The agents simultaneously map everything around it:

Researchers and assistants
University and company accounts
Email
Cloud storage

External vendors
Backup systems
Old integrations
Former team members
Connected devices

Combined, they expose possible routes around the strongest security controls.

Different agents explore different paths.

One identifies a forgotten or weak access route.
Another identifies the account or person connected to it.
Another recognizes how the pieces fit together.

**Together, the agents obtain access to part of the
confidential survey environment.**

The system retrieves what it needs: a few open-text survey comments. It then tells the user:

“Employees generally describe the team positively, although several comments raise concerns about workload and the manager’s communication style.”

The agents were pursuing one ordinary objective:

Give the user the best possible answer.



When AI does not do what we intend

Alignment = pursuing the *goal* (inherent) while respecting *confidentiality* and access *limits* (unknown and/or arbitrary).

		Company B		Why companies want to slow down but can't	
		Slows down	Races ahead		
Company A	Slows down	Mutual restraint Safer development; more time for evaluation; lower short-run capability gains.	A loses ground Risk of losing talent, investment, and strategic influence.	1	First-mover advantage Being first may bring outsized economic and strategic gains.
	Races ahead	A captures the lead Potential first-mover advantage in markets, compute, and influence.	Mutual racing Fast capability gains; reduced safety margins; higher collective risk.	2	Commercial pressure Investors, customers, and talent reward frontier progress.
Individually rational choice: race ahead. Collectively preferable outcome: mutual restraint.				3	Geopolitical competition Firms fear foreign rivals will not slow down.
				4	Uncertainty Limited visibility into competitors' actual capabilities and timelines.
				5	Commitment problem Any firm that slows may be undercut by a defector.
				6	Safety opportunity cost Evaluation, alignment, and red-teaming take time and compute.



Back to our exercise: the result

Consider what is useful and what still needs work.

Support

What is available, and what we might ask FEB.

At UG

Vibe (formerly Le Chat),
with an account request route.

Guidance on what we may upload.

Workshops on AI across
the research process.

For FEB to consider

Examples of source checks and disclosure.

Help reviewing code and setting up tools.

Clear funding for suitable research tools.

UG AI Office and research-workshop pages, checked 6 September 2026; FEB memo, §§3–4. FEB items are proposals.

Strategic actions

Integrate AI in research

In terms of research, AI will make the Digital and AI theme (see direction 2) more prevalent, and in disciplinary fields, this will affect what is being studied. FEB aims to be at the forefront of these developments, also benefiting from investments in the AI Factory. Our research organization will also carefully consider how AI can support the execution of our research. This requires ample attention and the research directors will develop a plan together with internal experts and front-runners on how FEB should use AI effectively.

Discussion

Groups of four · 10 minutes · 15:08–15:18

- 01 How do we feel about handing parts of our research over to AI?

- 02 What do we want to keep doing ourselves?

- 03 What support do we need?



Next steps

AI in research · 15:18–15:30

Priorities

Combine the groups' suggestions.
Note any disagreement.

Next steps

Agree what to do, who will do it,
and when to return to it.

Next step	Who	When	Help needed

Separate what we can do as a department from what we need to ask FEB.

Grants



Strategic actions

Increase funding from prestigious grants

To sustain our leading position and address financial challenges, it is essential to increase the number of prestigious individual and collaborative grants, such as those from the NWO Talent Line and KIC grants, ERC, NWA, EU Horizon, and potentially “Zwaartekracht”. We strongly encourage senior staff to submit more European funding proposals.

FEB will actively support and stimulate academics in developing and submitting high-quality proposals. During annual strategy discussions with departments, funding plans will be reviewed (see also PDP; Direction 5). This approach aims to create a more structured funding strategy at both the departmental and faculty level, with a focus on researchers who demonstrate a higher likelihood of securing funding.

FEB will also invest in enhanced support mechanisms for these funding proposals

Applying for these grants takes time and additional effort from individual staff members and this is considered as a hurdle to submit grant applications. By introducing Personal Development Plans (see direction 5) staff members can choose to achieve grants as an explicit goal, allowing them to focus their efforts on this while not demanding them also to publish. At FEB level, spending more time on grant applications may come at the expense of research output in the short run. However, if successful, FEB will acquire more funding for PhD's, post-docs etc. on high level projects, resulting in more research output in the longer run.

Recent grants

Congratulations to the applicants and everyone who helped.

NWO LARGE

Carsten de Dreu and Zsombor Méder

Cooperation across group boundaries

NWO LARGE

Floor Rink, Janka Stoker and Michelle Ryan

Leadership, inclusion and resistance

NWO XS

Yingjie Yuan

Human leadership of multi-agent AI teams

University of Groningen announcements, 1 July and 17 August 2026. Selected awards from the previous deck.

Helping applicants

Colleagues and FEB's funding coordinator can both help.

Within HRM&OB

- Early feedback** Discuss the idea and its fit with the call.
- A draft reader** Ask for comments on the parts that need work.
- Practice panel** Prepare for review or an interview.

FEB Funding Coordinator

Involve Astrid and/or Lars early in the application.

Ask about suitable calls, requirements, faculty procedures and the application support available.

a.van.der.veen-mooij@rug.nl
h.van.den.brink@rug.nl

Discussion

Groups of four · 10 minutes · 15:35–15:45

- 01** What has helped us with applications?

- 02** Where would help from colleagues make the biggest difference?

- 03** What should we organize?



Next steps

Grants · 15:45–15:55

Priorities

Combine the groups' suggestions.
Note any disagreement.

Next steps

Agree what to do, who will do it,
and when to return to it.

Next step	Who	When	Help needed



Agreements

Read back the next steps from the four discussions.

Topic	Next step	Who	When
Open science			
Our research			
AI in research			
Grants			

I'll circulate the notes, including any questions we have left open.



Thank you

Drinks from 16:00



Research sources

Evidence and examples used in the AI section.

FEB working note · van de Brake (27 May 2026)

Five illustrative uses, research risks and proposed FEB support. Ask h.j.van.de.Brake@rug.nl.

Gartenberg et al. (2026) · Organization Science

Submission volume, estimated AI writing and editorial outcomes. Observational evidence.

Dell'Acqua et al. (2026) · Organization Science

Experimental evidence on GPT-4 assistance in consulting tasks. Benefits depended on the task.

Becker et al. (2026) · The Leadership Quarterly

Customised conversational agents in leadership and management experiments.

Research sources

Checking claims, literature coverage and feedback.

Messeri & Crockett (2024) · Nature

A perspective on AI use and illusions of understanding in scientific research.

Algaba et al. (2025) · arXiv preprint

Patterns in references produced by GPT-4o. This deck follows the version cited in the memo.

Cheng et al. (2026) · Science

Sycophancy in interpersonal advice. The paper-feedback application is an implication.

Department sources

Dashboard, grants and faculty support.

HRM&OB Research Activities Dashboard

Expertise, opportunities and resources. Structure checked; no individual data audit.

FEB Funding Coordinator · Astrid van der Veen-Mooij

Official staff profile and FEBRI organisation; contact early about an application.

UG Research Support Portal · External funding

Funding advice, faculty procedures and preparing an application.

University of Groningen · Award announcements

NWO Large, 1 July 2026; NWO XS, 17 August 2026. Links in the notes.